November 2026
50th Year of Growth
1976 - 2026

Contact Email: secretary@doncastergardenclubaus.com
Web Address: www.doncastergardenclubaus.com

The DGC committee meeting was held on 4 November 2026 at 7.30 pm.
The next DGC meeting will be held on **Wednesday, 11 November 2026**
7.30 pm at the RSL Hall , cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street. Doors open at 7.15pm

This is our AGM and the speaker for this meeting will be Helen Lovel from Nutrog

Committee Members 2026

President
Avril Clark
0402 478 302
president@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Vice-President & Speaker Bookings:
Vacant

Treasurer:
Dr Margaret Salter

Secretary:
Virgina Roberts & Connie Lee
secretary@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Fund Raising Co-Ordinator:
Anita Luzza

Newsletter:
Rohini Padey
newseditor@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Reinhard

Esther Sim

Ray Brett

President's message.

Thank you all for the splendid turnout to our 50th birthday celebrations! I enjoyed sharing this milestone with all of you and now we begin the business of preparing for the next 50 years!
On Wednesday we will have our AGM when you have your chance to vote for your Committee members. This is an important part of Club life and how you can contribute. Although Committee numbers are set by the rules governing our Club you can still contribute your ideas, questions and requests through the elected members.
The wonderful October and early November rain has really spurred the garden on (and the weeds!) although the fluctuating temperatures are not helping good germination. I am wanting to plant cucumbers, spinach, zucchini, lettuce and carrots but I shall have to protect them so they don't wash away.

I am hoping that we will have a dry day at least for my Open Garden on Saturday 14th November. We have been rained out the last two years! Please make sure you let me know if you are coming as well as your phone number so that I can contact you in the event of torrential rain.

We are always glad to receive your suggestions for speakers and topics for the Club. It is important though to provide us with the topic and a contact point for the speaker. The 2027 calendar is now full and we hope that the variety and the topics will inspire you.

It is my pleasure to inform you that our member Maureen Lucas has been appointed as the Vice President of The Garden Clubs of Australia. Congratulations !!

Happy Gardening for the rest of the year!

Doncaster Garden Club Subscriptions are due for renewal by the 31st October 2026

Please bring your returnable bottles and cans each month so we can collect the 10c deposit to add to the DGC financial reserve. (No squashed cans please)

Hello Gardeners All

I'm sure I saw a coddling moth mid October. They hatch out of pupation at 15-16deg Celsius. Females lay Eggs at night when temperature is 15deg or more. Here is some AI info:

How Rain Indirectly Helps Control Them : While the rain won't wash away or kill the pupae, heavy downpours and the cool, wet spring seasons often seen in parts of Australia (such as Victoria or South Australia) crush codling moth pressure in other ways: pir.sa.gov.au

Adult Moths Halts Mating: Adult moths require warm dusk temperatures (above 15°C–16°C) to fly and mate. Cold wind and heavy rain severely limit flight, preventing them from finding mates or tracking pheromones.

Eggs Suppresses Hatching: Continued rain keeps temperatures below their reproductive threshold, preventing successful egg-laying and development.

New Larvae Physical Mortality: Young, newly hatched caterpillars trying to migrate from leaves into the fruit face a high risk of being physically dislodged, washed away, or drowned by heavy rain.

To help control coddling moth (Sustainable Gardening Australia)

Hang a commercially available pheromone lure and trap in the tree – this attracts the moths and they get stuck on the sticky inner surface.

Make your own traps out of old plastic bottles with 2 holes cut in the sides about 2 cm above the base and add a 50:50 mix of molasses and water. Check them every few weeks

When the rain did not come On 24th , I planted sweet corn , bean and cucumber seeds in the garden. Now I'm hoping they have not been either washed away, or stay too wet & rot. I do feel for our farmers.

We were away from the 12th to 19th and the green caterpillars had a ball in the developing cauliflowers! Leaves were decimated or big parts missing. I picked them pronto as the sun was on them. They were smaller than I had hoped for.

The damp soil caused me to lift the garlic early as some fell over and all were too damp. Most are a reasonable size and are drying on the patio. They do not like rain when trying to mature.

Bought capsicum seedlings and one eggplant are in. Now we need warm weather for growth. Pumpkin seeds are popping up 2 leaves in toilet rolls which makes them so easy to transplant. This year there is a nice mound of compost in the bed to transplant a couple.

Trevor has dropped nets over the stone fruit to protect them from Queensland fruit fly. There is also baits of Wild May Hanging. The apple tree also has a coddling both bait in it and nets ready to drop.

As the olive is too large to net, I bought a QFF bait with a proper poison inside a jar. This is suppose to attract male QFF from 400m. As the poison is not a spray it will not affect any other plant.

The 2 boysenberry vines have nearly completed flowering and the fruit is growing well. They can give 2kg each season (except the year with a vine hopper invasion). The Raspberry bushes are about 600mm high. If I nip the growing point at that height (this will be e 1st year) they should bush and crop heavier.

The rain on 30th was on and off but with generous showers when 'on'. October skies gave this house 70.8 mm

Spare plants and seeds

1. I have seed pods of freshly dried bok choy anyone is welcome to.

2. The Raspberry bushes are putting out little suckered plants - free to a good home. Raspberries can be contained from suckering by planting in a big pot, placed on bricks, so the attempts to sucker can be snipped off. This variety are cut back totally each winter.

3. My excess Yacon bulbs are shooting in the soil and can be transplanted. Grow in rich soil for a delicious, sweet and juicy edible root, raw or stir fry.

Sms me to arrange. Growing a few food items adds to your food security if we have a severe summer with rising fuel prices.

Did you know Australian blueberries are now allowed, legally, to have a 500% increase in residual poisons on them? Grow your own clean alternative!

Until Next time, Happy Gardening Pauline

Lynchnis Campion, magenta colour - a flower from a cottage garden.



From my Bookshelf November 2026

I have been obsessed with herbs ever since I was young. One of my greatest joys was watching the tips of new chives peep through the soil after the snow had finished. Scrambled eggs with chives would still have to be a big favourite.

It should not surprise you therefore to find that I have quite a few books on herbs on my bookshelf.

The first one is The Encyclopedia of Herbs and Herbalism edited by Malcolm Stuart, 1979.

Like all good encyclopedias it covers every aspect of herbs – the history of herbalism; the biology and chemistry of plants; the medicinal uses of plants; herbs in the kitchen; the domestic and cosmetic uses of herbs; cultivation, collection and preservation of herbs. My particular interests are the medieval use of herbs in healing and health and cooking with herbs.

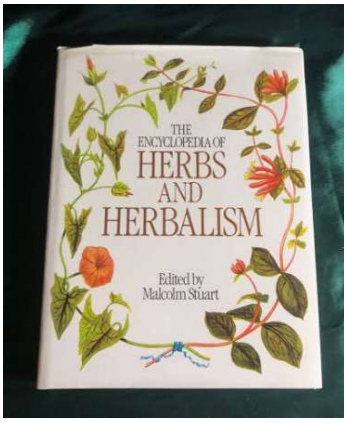
The next book is Herbs for Australian gardens by Penny Woodward, 2008.

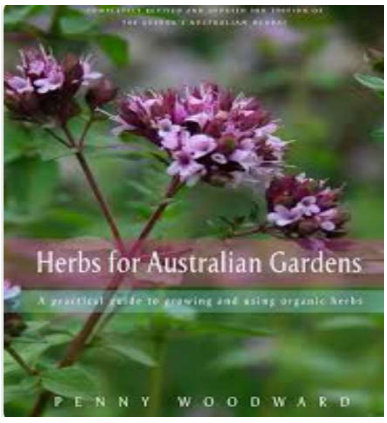
This book, as its name suggests is much more specific and covers all aspects of the growing of herbs in depth, as well as companion planting and pest repellent herbs. Penny's book also has a chapter on useful weeds and useful Australian native plants. The topics , in this book , are very comprehensively covered making it a valuable resource for the growing of herbs, especially in Australia.

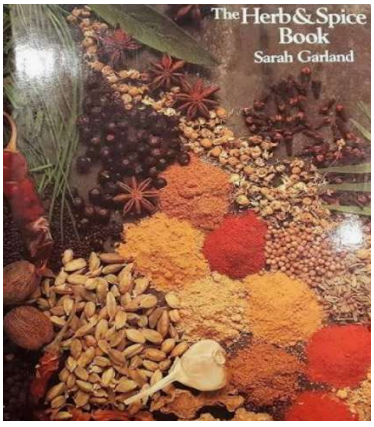
The third book is The Herb and Spice Book by Sarah Garland,1979.

This book provides a modern herbal, how to design a herb garden and all aspects of growing and propagating them, cooking with herbs and spices, many of the recipes coming from medieval Europe and Asia, household herbs and spices, cosmetic herbs and herbs for health.

Although I have many other books on herbs and spices as well each offers a different perspective. Many of the books published are European in origin so it is very valuable to have Penny Woodward's book specifically relating to Australia.







Do you this is a Problem ? Too much sun causes pink/purple colour. No problems! Increased anthocyanins. It vanished with cooking.



Upcoming Calendar Events:

Upcoming Committee Meeting:	**04 November**	hosted by Avril Clark, 7.30pm at 62 Pine Hill Drive Doncaster East
Upcoming Meeting:	**11 November**	at the RSL Hall, 7.30pm at cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street Doncaster East

Following Committee Meeting:	**02 December**	hosted by Avril Clark, 7.30pm at 62 Pine Hill Drive Doncaster East
Christmas Party – Dinner	**09 December**	Venue To be announced

Open Garden at Avril Clark's house

Saturday14th November, 2.30 - 4pm

RSVP with name and phone no (in case we get rained out!) by Wednesday 11th November

Avril@spiritofprogress.net

Here is what to plant in the Garden in November

Vegetable Planting Guide For Melbourne | All Green Nursery & Garden



Hardenbergia is edible - a member of the Pea family. This article gives ideas & recipes to use it's various parts.

https://sharingideas.me/unlocking-the-power-of-false-sarsaparilla-homemade-uses-and-benefits-of-hardenbergia-violacea/?sfnsn=mo

Seen at Tunstall Square late October. A pair of Swallows with eggs. See the cable to the speaker. I think she found a warm spot.



CARNIVAL OF FLOWERS, TOOWOOMBA

Hello gardeners

Last September I visited Brisbane, and while there I travelled to Toowoomba to see the Carnival of Flowers. This is an annual event held over 21/2 weeks near the centre of Toowoomba. This year it was held between 18 Sept and 5 Oct. The main attraction is a huge display of over 50,000 annuals, perennials and bulbs, where talented horticulturists have created works of art using flowering plants.

The plants include pansies, petunias, snap dragons, dianthus, fox gloves, delphiniums and many others. The plants are mostly in 2 parks, the Laurel Bank park and the Botanic Garden in Queens park. These are both within easy walking distance of central Toowoomba, and there are shuttle buses going to these parks.

In addition to these floral displays there are other activities, including music, gourmet food, open private gardens, ferris wheel, and train trips to a garden station. At the opening of the Carnival there is a grand parade with colourful floats and performers through the centre of Toowoomba.

As with the parade, some of these events are not held every day, so suggest that you check the website before visiting Toowoomba.

To get to Toowoomba the website is not very helpful, as it says Toowoomba is an easy 2 hours drive from Brisbane. Not helpful if you have not come to Brisbane by car! However Toowoomba can be reached by Greyhound bus from Roma St bus terminal which is next to the Roma St train station. The bus that I took departed Brisbane at 7am and arrived in Toowoomba just after 9am. The fare was about $80 return. Don't consider going by train as it only goes 2 times a week.

I wouldn't say that it is worth a trip to Queensland just for the Carnival, unless you can get a good airfare, but worth going to if you are in Queensland at this time. The date for the Carnival of Flowers next year is 17 Sept to 4 Oct.

There are also gardens in Brisbane worth visiting. The Brisbane Botanic garden probably doesn't need mentioning, but less well known is the Roma St parkland. This used to be a rail yard but has been converted into a beautiful park and garden. This is next to the Roma St bus terminal.

Article Courtesy - RON THOMSON









DGC Life Members

Gerda van der Peet
Doug Brewer
Gayle McCann
Ted Page

Joanne Driver
Elsie Carter
Bev Turner
Franziska Kung









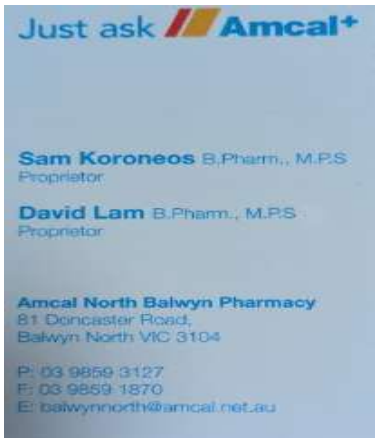


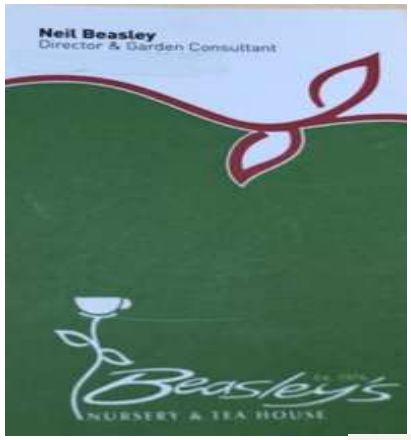
The Ryset Catalogue can https://ryset.com

The Club receives wholesale prices which means discounts of up to 60-70%















Please support our sponsors

Let them know you are a member of DGC and appreciate how they help us.